

Paper Directions 30 — my read (Sep 4, 2026)

Source: [transcripts/20260904_Paper_Directions_30_otter_ai_transcript.docx](#) (~10:55)
Context: Charles walked Alex through all Big Fish storyboards — 3×3 data stories + perf metric story decks (MBB, tenure, legends, football).
Prior: [PD29_notes.md](#) · storyboards: [../3-Master_Plan/re_entry/HEROs_and_PASSes/](#)

Headline

Priority flip: Big Fish porch screening is **done enough for now**. Alex wants **paper talk / flipbook / chapter outline** as the **primary intellectual lift**; tenure scrape + Big Fish domains move to **background** (train nights, fallback portfolio).

- Alex (portfolio):** “I didn’t want data to be the limitation... backup plans... backup on our backup plan.”
- Alex (time):** “I don’t want this to become the dominant time sink in the next few weeks... **back burner side gig**... only becomes primary if we need it as a fallback.”
- Alex (story):** “The big one is **what’s the story?**”

Primary trio unchanged: Army · MBB · Tenure stay on the table. Big Fish (legends, football, education, ...) = **enrichment / contingency**, not the main bet.

Flipbook bootstrap: [_DISPOSABLE_paper_flipbook_PD30.md](#) · Campaign plan: [PAPER_Campaign_Plan.md](#)

Transcript note: Otter heard “cat card” → CAC (Common Access Card).

Charles lock (Sep 4, post-call): Army data **strongly** produces the inverted-U — that is the **scientific anchor**. MBB work continued because we had the data during the CAC gap; when the card returns, **re-center the flipbook on army**. See flipbook § Charles lock.

Transcript arc

Block	Time	Content
Storyboard tour	00:00–03:48	Two deck types (3×3 + perf metric Q16/EW16); tenure metrics (career rate, cum pubs, annum pubs); legends weak; football composite fails
Usage hook	03:16–03:41	Alex: “ Usage is very interesting. Why is it? ” — Charles to dig in (post-call: CFBD touch share; LOO vs T_j congestion story)
Contingency framing	03:51–06:00	CAC still needed; data won’t vanish; backup domains; perf-metric screen for “what has promise”; MBB “still worked”
Agent / panels	06:00–07:38	Alex’s panels = limited agent prompt; Charles can rebuild from raw with HERO model in mind; not dominant time sink
Primary redirect	07:38–10:03	Background: tenure + Big Fish poke; primary = flipbook + paper outline + story nuggets ; β_2 scan OK in background
Close	10:03–10:53	Train / Jamie Blument; “Is this what you were looking for?” — yes

Alex verdict — by deck (Sep 4)

Domain	3×3 / reigning HERO	Perf metric story	Alex line
MBB	Familiar (prior work)	(shown in tour)	Weaker than before but “ still worked ” — don’t discount
Tenure	Steep-ish; sparse outliers	Career rate · cum pubs · annum pubs (+ 10-bin page ✓)	Noisy annum row expected; more scrape → sharper
Legends	No HERO	One component “ kind of works, pretty weak ”	Not a lead domain
Football	Composite “ doesn’t work ”	Usage row “very interesting”	Composite dead; usage worth understanding
Education	Not shown live	—	“Whole different ball game” — Charles to dig in

Charles framing Alex accepted: Perf metric storyboard = right attack to **flog death rates fast** across metrics before investing.

Alex ask — priority stack (PD30)

#	Tier	Task	Detail
P0	Primary	Paper flipbook / talk outline	Question → figure → 1–2 sentence claim; “nuggets that go boom”; chapter/paper shape
P1	Background	Tenure + academic scrape	Continue fill; sparse-dept outliers should improve
P2	Background	Big Fish portfolio	Keep poking one domain at a time ; perf-metric screen; usage deep-dive (football)
P3	Background	COMPASS / Scholar β_2 scan	Fit quadratic · negative β_2 → flag only; no report unless hit
P4	Contingency	CAC (Common Access Card) / army access	Matt Davis: data preserved; card still required for access
P5	Optional rebuild	HERO-aware panels from raw	Same sources as Alex panels but agent knows model (esp. Legends logs → aggregates)

Explicitly NOT primary: spinning on Big Fish until one “works” as hard as MBB/tenure.

Domain status after PD30

Domain	Role	Notes
Army	Primary (anchor)	Strong inverted-U ; “very good” with CAC access; data retention confirmed; narrative lead when card returns
MBB	Primary (replication)	Working stand-in while CAC out; “still worked” — don’t discount
MBB	Primary	Congestion principle stands; effect weaker but viable
Tenure	Primary	Still on table; PD29 locks hold; scrape incomplete
Football	Backup / teach	Composite porch fail; usage LOO = pedagogical congestion win (T_j flat vs LOO steep)
Legends	Backup	Weak signal; keep in portfolio
NELS / HSB / Apache	Backup queue	Education “different ball game” — explore when background time

Post-call repo work (same day — not in transcript)

Charles + COMPASS after the call:

- **Usage defined:** CFBD offensive usage share (touch/opportunity, not NBA rate).
- **** T_j vs LOO twin:**** `football_sandbox/perf_story/FOOTBALL_usage_Tj_q16_ew16.png` — team mean flat (~9%→7%), LOO steep (~16%→4%); talk track in `FOOTBALL_DATA_STORY_plot_highlights.md`.

For next Alex touch: usage LOO supports congestion story even where Δ composite porch is flat.

Delta vs PD29

PD29	PD30
50/50 data vs paper outline	Paper outline now wins ; Big Fish demoted to back burner
Legends + football “incoming”	Shown — legends weak, football usage interesting
Tenure locks (T1–T6)	Unchanged ; still primary
Perf metric storyboard	Alex validated as screening tool

Thread log

Date	Entry
2026-09-04	PD30 ingested; primary = flipbook/story; Big Fish = backup; football usage flagged; T_j vs LOO doc’d.